

Perspectives from a Tech-Driven Community: Code, Care, and Regeneration

By Jillian Hovey, Roberto Valenti, Simon Quarmby, and Laura van Wijngaarden



An Eco-Tech Hub

By Jillian Hovey

Liminal Village is an intentional community in central Italy, a 20-minute drive inland from the east coast on the Adriatic Sea. While living in Amsterdam, cofounders Roberto Valenti and Laura van Wijngaarden envisioned a living place where personal growth, technology, and nature could meet. They found a three-hectare property with three houses in Roberto's home province of Ascoli Piceno, and in 2018, they made the big move there with their newborn child. They then began the eco development of the site.

Roberto had the vision of an eco-tech hub, where technology is guided by the patterns of nature. As one way of bringing this desire to life, he organized time at Liminal Village in "Lunations." This is the term for the lunar cycles which run from one new moon to the next. Guests are encouraged to arrive with the new moon and remain for a "moonth." This connects people with a common natural arc of time, where we follow what Roberto calls "the progress bar in the sky." Because the entire planet is under the same moon, this offers a simple yet profound way to align our working rhythms, whether together on site or collaborating remotely.

I have lived and worked at Liminal Village during several lunations over the past four years. I have witnessed the usual tensions that arise in any community, as well as challenges particular to the community's focus on technology. Many who come to Liminal Village are primarily drawn by its tech work and regenerative context, but do not necessarily come from the communities movement. Visitors often have limited experience of living and

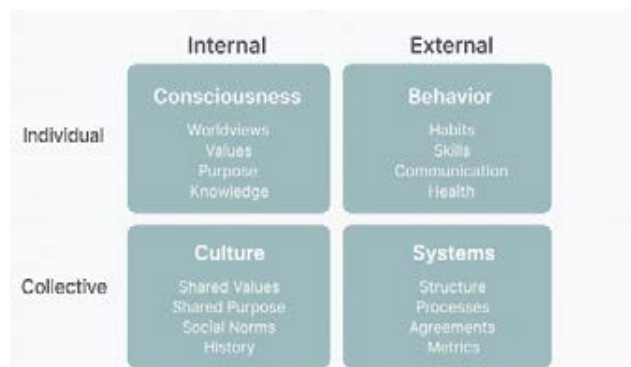
working closely with others, and are therefore earlier in the process of developing the intra- and interpersonal skills fundamental to intentional community life. This is a strong contributor to the challenging community dynamics that have occurred.

Integral Framework

As well as working closely with Roberto, a few months after my first stay I began mentoring Laura, and we have been on a deep journey together ever since. Early on, we engaged with the "Four Quadrants" of Ken Wilber's Integral Theory (*see diagram*). This model illuminates the often-hidden *Interior* dimensions of our *Personal* and *Collective* lives—realms of feelings, values, and culture. These aspects of our existence are overshadowed by Western culture's emphasis on the *Exterior* world of science, economics, and technology.

The Four Quadrants gave Laura a language for what she was sensing, and also for what she had been suppressing in her life, and in Liminal Village. Bringing this "other side" of reality into view connected Laura with more of her *whole self*, and helped her find her voice in the community. Laura's inputs and feedback did not always align with the values or habits familiar to the mostly male-identifying tech folks, yet she has profoundly influenced the growth of Liminal Village's frame of reference toward an Integral perspective. This expansion to include interior aspects of people and groups also helped us understand that technology should reflect not just external systems, but also the inner values and cultures that shape how we live together.

This article shares perspectives on the journey of Liminal Village from three others besides me: cofounders Roberto and Laura, along with long-term community participant Simon Quarmby.



The Four Quadrants of the Integral Framework by Ken Wilber.

Computer-Aided Communities

By Roberto Valenti

I consider myself a conscious technologist, as my ongoing focus revolves around developing technologies that serve life. I have often stood in the liminal space where opposites meet and transform—the spaces between technology and nature, individual and collective, tradition and innovation, structure and flow. These intersections are at the heart of Liminal Village—the “living lab” I cofounded seven years ago with my wife Laura. Indeed, our marriage embodies this dynamic of the liminal space between two different entities—two people searching for common ground, and learning from each other along the way. I am humbled by what our journey has brought us, and glad to share some of these learnings in this collective article. My aim is neither to promote nor to reject technology, but to redefine its role—consciously integrating it into communities so that it serves life, instead of enslaving it or aiding the destruction of the planet.

Affordances and Requirements

Every technology carries both *affordances* (what it makes possible) and *requirements* (what it demands in return). A solar panel for example, affords “free” renewable energy, but very few people could build one themselves—an entire industrial chain

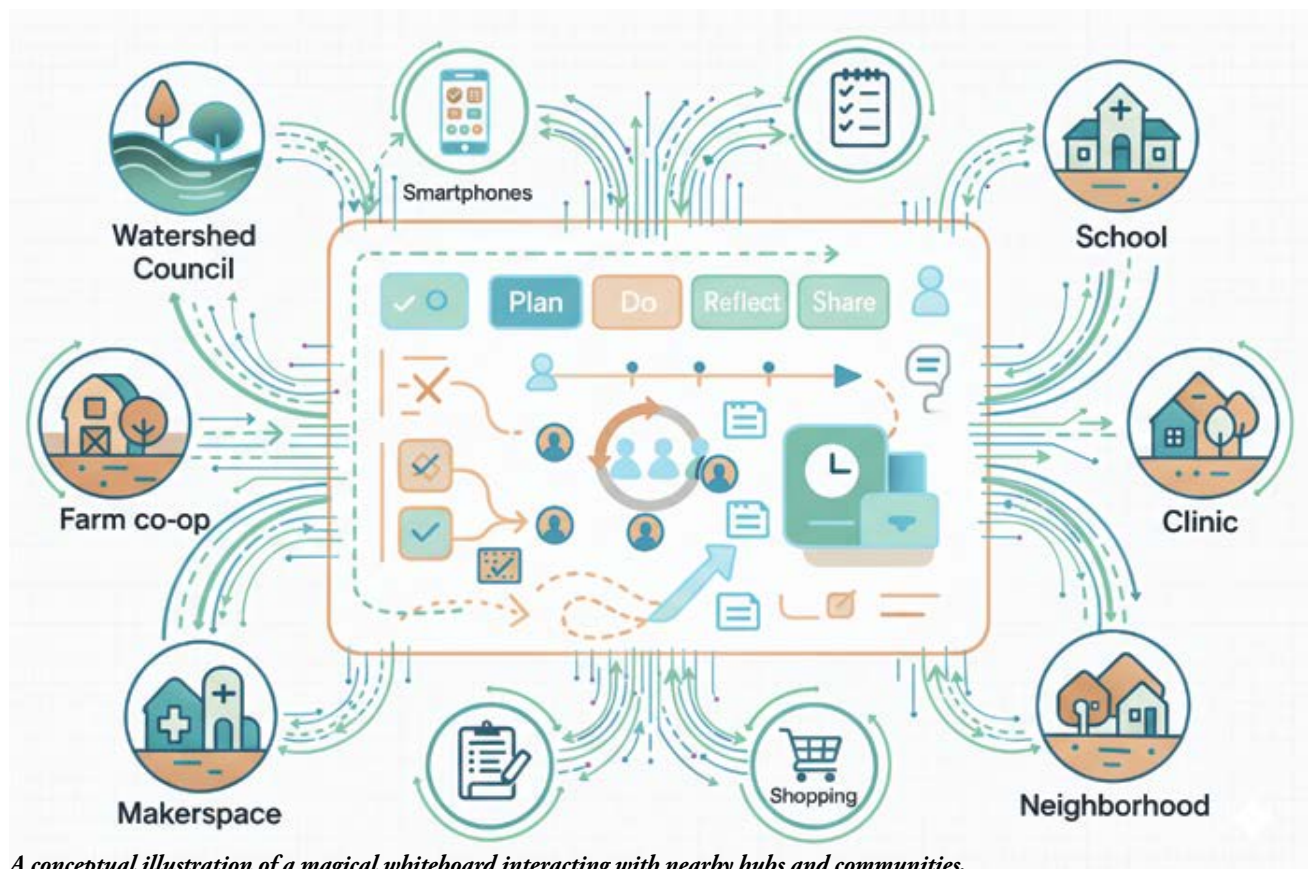
is required to produce it. This distinction matters because what looks like *independence* (a solar panel on a roof) is in fact *dependent* on vast supply chains and infrastructures.

The same is true for *social technologies*—models, frameworks, shared routines, and patterns of interaction, such as Nonviolent Communication, Liberating Structures, or Sociocracy. These tools *afford* immense value by improving collaboration, deepening trust, and making collective decisions more effective. Yet they also *require* teaching, learning, and ongoing practice, often with the support of a trained facilitator.

Even something as simple as a whiteboard in a community kitchen is a form of social technology. It requires people to use it, and it affords coordination of meals, tasks, and schedules with nothing more than a marker and an erasable surface. Low-cost and easy to adopt, such tools quickly become indispensable once a community makes them part of daily life.

“Magical Whiteboards”

Now imagine this simple whiteboard evolving into a “magical whiteboard”—a shared canvas of action and memory, where items and intentions sync seamlessly within and across communities. Such a tool could unlock powerful affordances, such as shared visibility, real-time coordination, and a collective memory. This technology could cut duplication of effort, facilitate cross-community learning, and amplify local signals into the wider network—helping weave countless small actions into coherent, large-scale impact.



A conceptual illustration of a magical whiteboard interacting with nearby hubs and communities.

AI-generated by Gemini

A “magical whiteboard” requires electricity, internet, and digital devices. If those requirements are already met (for example, smartphones in most people’s pockets, wireless connectivity), and it makes use of an easy-to-use touch or speech interface, the cost of unlocking these higher affordances is relatively small. Yet, even when the infrastructure is available, the cultural requirements of a tool can be more significant than its technical demands: tools, once introduced, begin to reshape patterns of behavior.

When Tools Shape Culture

During one of our lunations, we experimented with a mutual credit system, tracking exchanges of effort on a simple whiteboard with pluses and minuses. It was low-tech, transparent, and easy to use. Yet a significant shift occurred in our temporary community: once they began being accounted for, tasks which previously were seemingly offered as spontaneous gifts now started to feel transactional rather than part of the natural flow of community life.

This realization was a wake-up call: even the simple act of “accounting” can have an effect on people’s behaviour and community dynamics. A mutual credit system might be a great replacement for money between distant communities that cannot directly see one another’s contributions, but within a close-knit circle, it risked corroding the very culture of trust and generosity we hoped to nurture.

Fragility and Fallbacks

The real question is not whether a technology is “good” or “bad,” but what the trade-offs are. Do the affordances justify the requirements? What new dependencies are created; what freedoms are gained; what culture does it foster? And crucially: what happens if the systems fail? Technological adoption should always come with a fallback. If the internet goes down, a community can still use a simple whiteboard; if the solar panel fails, there should be another way to meet essential energy needs. Without such fallback layers, technologies can precipitate dependencies and points of fragility.

The lack of fallbacks, the technological requirements, and unintuitive interfaces are all potential explanations of why many intentional communities instinctively keep digital technology at arm’s length. I believe there is also a deeper reason for the rejection: today’s digital technologies (social media, online mar-

ketplaces, devices, and communication apps) are deliberately designed around economic incentives that drive attention capture, data extraction, planned obsolescence, and vendor lock-in. Furthermore, without truly “cradle-to-cradle” systems of production and re-use—where devices are modular, designed to be returned, easily melted down, and reshaped into new versions with minimal resource loss—the environmental cost of churning out “shiny new” products each year is staggering. Instead of closing the loop, most devices are discarded, polluting, and wasting the rare minerals, energy, and labor embedded in them.

The current social and environmental costs of digital technologies are significant. Yet these burdens are not inevitable requirements of the technology itself, but the result of the underlying profit drive which has created it. The digital ecosystem was optimized for extraction and revenue rather than well-being, which turns humans into buying addicts, and their attention and relationships into the product. Not everyone is willing to accept that bargain.

Money as Operating System

I have witnessed first-hand how the profit drive can undermine the intention of tech development. During my PhD, collaborations across groups broke down over funding and questions of who would get credit for the work. Later, in the AI companies that spun off from my academic work, financial pressures pulled our innovations away from what we truly wanted to create—toward “whatever makes money.” The good I had hoped to create was repeatedly warped by market forces.

The pervasive “requirement” for profit made me realize that *the monetary system may be the most mind-controlling technology of all!* It acts as the de facto operating system of society and much of our relationship with the Earth—shaping our choices, actions, and behaviors. Money affords us a simple way to trade, but at devastating costs: our interdependence is hidden, organizations become competing silos, ancient forests are cut, seas are over-fished, unrecyclable goods are produced, and ecosystems are polluted. This is not out of overt desire, but because survival within the system demands it.



People using technology inappropriately, disconnecting from a typically social situation.



“Money makes the world go around,” but results in extractive behaviour, wealth gaps, and environmental degradation, thus leaving human and ecological well-being impoverished.

AI-generated by Gemini



The networked locations of *regenerativa.earth* around the Tronto River watershed, Italy.



The holonic dashboard on a fridge—a “magical whiteboard” showcasing the active tasks in our family and in our related communities at the local and global level.



The holonic dashboard showcasing local tasks and events.



The holonic dashboard showcasing tasks surfaced at the watershed level.

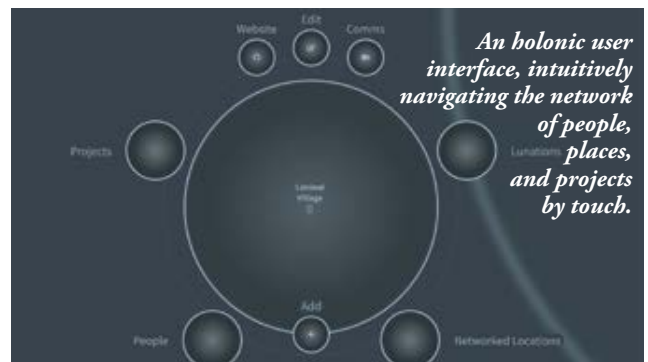
Regenerative Economics

Realizing the depth of today’s economic distortions made me question whether another path was possible. Could we design economic technologies that, instead of eroding our values, would actually uphold them? Imagine rewriting the rules so that economies are grounded not in arbitrary commodities, but in what we truly cherish: regeneration, care, education, sharing, and free time. In such a values-based system, doing the “right thing” would no longer be a matter of personal ethics alone, but also the natural outcome of a just economic design. What we now dismiss as “externalities” (care work, volunteering, ecological stewardship) would finally be recognized and rewarded. *The health of our relationships, our ecosystems, and our inner lives would become the true currencies of wealth*, weaving resilience and meaning back into daily life.

Liminal Village has been a living laboratory for this vision. We designed and tested social and digital systems. We lived in the feedback loops of using our own technology in daily life (“eating our own dog food,” as developers say), celebrating breakthroughs, stumbling into limits, and always learning. Each experiment revealed something about what strengthens community and what can corrode it. The goal was never just to build tools, but to embed our values into habits and agreements that help us thrive together while we heal the planet.

Designing for Interdependence

For too long, technology has reinforced the illusion of self-



sufficiency. Re-imagined, digital technology could instead make our interdependence visible and workable—supporting trust, enabling values-aligned communication, and allowing communities to coordinate across scales, from households to global networks. This is *technology in service of cooperation*, not isolation.

At regenerativa.earth we are in the early stages of developing a computer-aided, fractal network of people, projects, and places, focused on Integral regeneration. Our digital tools will allow needs and resources to be shared openly, so coordination becomes possible. Families, schools, and associations could list under-utilized items, borrow, lend, or co-buy resources through trusted local groups. Over time, these exchanges could evolve into community-owned businesses and infrastructure, and eventually into decentralized supply chains, where citizens and coop-

eratives pool resources, track flows, and share rewards. What may begin as a simple Telegram bot becomes the scaffolding of a new economy—transparent, cooperative, and regenerative.

Anyone who has lived in community is familiar with the operational load: meals to prepare, spaces to maintain, repairs to make, inventories to track, people to support, etc. Often this physical and mental load is carried by a few, who continuously (willingly or unwillingly) anchor this work, which can lead to imbalance and to tensions, and ultimately to community breakdown.

Here technology can play a vital role. Rather than centralizing control, it can distribute visibility, coordination, and responsibility across the whole. Our “magical whiteboard” could evolve into a cybernetic guidance system within and between communities with shared social DNA, actively proposing synergetic step-by-step pathways toward common goals—one clear, actionable task at a time. In this way, the same principles that link villages to bioregions can also help distribute the work of cooking, repairing, and caring. Our meetings then become less about logistics, and more about connection, reflection, and learning.

Choosing Consciously

From the moment our ancestors first shaped stone into tools, technology has walked beside us—an intimate companion in our becoming. We mold it, and it molds us. The art lies in discernment: to use technology as a tool, not a weapon; as scaffold, not a cage; as a guide, not an overlord. Will we allow profit-driven systems to keep writing the code of our lives, or shall we reclaim technology as an ally of regeneration, weaving care, creativity, and community into the fabric of our shared future?

I carry the conviction that a computer-aided regenerative economy can catalyze a world where sustainable lifestyles and initiatives thrive, designed to meet the needs of both people and the planet. We invite you to step into this vision with us. Whether you are a coder, a creative, a builder, or a weaver, there is a place on our “magical whiteboard” for your gifts, and each contribution is an opportunity to access the living laborato-

ries where this future is already being practiced. Together, we can weave the living laboratories of today into the regenerative economies of tomorrow.

From the "Belly of the Beast" to Liminal Village

By Simon Quarmby

Perhaps like many reading this article, I once lived a very different life—disconnected from nature and community, embroiled in the callous churn of competition, consumerism, and convenience. In 2018, at the pinnacle of my career working for Big Tech in London, I ejected myself from the “belly of the beast,” in search of a more meaningful life.

After the trauma of my exit from the corporate world, which was a time plagued with immense stress, depression, loneliness, and lack of purpose, I ran away. I vowed never to return to corporate life, and exiled the parts of me that I associated with my breakdown. To rationalize all of this, I told myself I’d taken very early retirement.

I had the financial means to travel. After spending a lifetime in the city, I sought out a tropical climate and a taste of Latin culture. I fell in love with a beautiful Colombian woman, who aspired to build up her Airbnb business on the picturesque Caribbean coast of Santa Marta. That felt good to me, and so I spent the next three years escaping my nightmare by living her dream. We were successful, but something was missing—I felt trapped in paradise. Like many, my experience of the pandemic was one of awakening to the challenges our species was facing, and I felt called to seek out my own purpose in service to something greater.

So I upped and left—throwing myself into the unknown again. On my seeking journey, I experienced what it was like to



Simon with Mama Alejo and family in the Sierra Nevada de Santa Marta as we forged an alliance for regeneration in the bioregion.



Our regenerative alliance gathered a crowd of local activists and indigenous leaders from the Sierra Nevada de Santa Marta bioregion as we worked together to map relationships.



The paradise view from the Airbnb we managed on the Caribbean Coast.



A gathering with some leaders from the three remaining tribes of the Sierra Nevada de Santa Marta, in Menguiguaca.

live in community and sought out regenerative projects—first in hostels and coliving arrangements, then on an agroforestry project in the jungle; a plastic recycling initiative in Panama; and eventually seeding a bioregional movement and forming alliances with the indigenous tribes in the Sierra Nevada de Santa Marta. Through plant medicine, I experienced the dissolution of my own ego, tasted paradise through the eyes of nature, bore witness to my own greed, and glimpsed the world through indigenous tradition and values. I began to see nature and community as important pillars in my life.

Finding Regenerative Finance

In the latter part of my time in London, I had become seduced by the dream of a “crypto-utopia”—the vision that blockchain and digital currencies could liberate people from broken institutions and create a fairer world. As my thesis matured, I had begun to imagine ways in which our technology, particularly our financial system, could be re-deployed for good, in service to nature and community—all we had to do was measure and value the right things. I stumbled upon the concept of “regenerative finance,” or “ReFi,” where many were trying to do just that: tokenizing tree planting, or even minting non-fungible tokens (NFTs) to represent land parcels as stores of ecological value.

Even as I studied permaculture, I was looking for patterns: how could we learn from nature to build more coherent, regenerative systems for society; how could we resolve the apparent paradoxes between the individual and the collective, freedom and responsibility, spirituality and technology...nature and the machine? I found hope in the bioregional movement through Joe Brewer, who became a good friend. He helped me understand that where the “Crypto Bros” were trying to make our systems “trust-less,” the key to social and environmental regeneration was in nurturing “trust-full” relationships. Reducing everything to a number so that our broken economy could see it was not the answer.

I wrestled with post-capitalist, post-colonial, and even post-monetary thought, all in search of answers, which seemed to be outside of our grasp. The question kept arising: “If our socioeconomic framework was truly broken—our way of being and level of consciousness so misaligned with nature—if so many were suffering, then what was the right way to live, and how could we ever reach the scale needed for a global transition?”

Prophecy of the Eagle and the Condor

In the Prophecy of the Eagle and the Condor—a legend woven into the heritage of many indigenous peoples of the Americas—the Eagle embodies masculine energies: analytical thought, logic, reason, industrial might, and technological advancement. Conversely, the Condor symbolizes feminine energies, encompassing care, compassion, connection to the Earth, and community.

This ancient prophecy foretold a period, beginning approximately 500 years ago, when the masculine and feminine energies would fall out of balance. This era of the ascendancy of the Eagle coincided with the European incursion into the Americas, and the subsequent colonization and subjugation of indigenous cultures by industrial and technological progress. The Eagle’s dominance privileged the abstraction of value, the objectification and exploitation of nature and society, and the prioritization of profit over care. According to the prophecy, we have now entered a new age of restoration and balance, where the Eagle and the Condor will soar together once again.

Of course, at this time in our human journey, it’s easy to perceive the machine of our economy as a perpetual, relentless engine of growth, externalising cost to nature with disregard for care and community, still putting profit over purpose, desecrating the sacred in service to the myth of progress. Modern technology, including AI, is accelerating at an exponential pace, and has been shaped by these very forces. There are, however, seeds of hope: the evolution of the Global Ecovillage Network (GEN), the re-emergence of the bioregional movement, and the success of regenerative projects all over the world. And where our technology is put in service to this care, we can begin to imagine these two majestic birds once again flying in the same sky.

Liminal Village

In 2023, I had my first stint at Liminal Village in Italy, and I’ve spent nine months of the last two years there. During that first stay, Roberto had started to introduce to the community some of the technology he had been building. It was an exchange: Roberto and Laura were offering the infrastructure of Liminal Village and dedicating their time to hosting us, and in return asked only for a contribution to the grocery bill and our participation in this experiment in post-monetary, post-capitalist life. I was excited to be a part of it!



Initially, without the context of Roberto's greater vision, some of the technology felt intrusive and unnecessary to me. The idea of using a phone application to "appreciate" someone was well intentioned, but it felt unnatural—much better to say thank you to someone in person, or just return the favor, I thought. Managing community tasks through Telegram, rather than with a whiteboard and pen, also felt like overkill. The shopping list feature was quite neat, though, and really helped us to coordinate meeting everyone's needs asynchronously.

The talks amongst the people we attracted were the most stimulating, most revolutionary conversations I'd ever experienced. The works of Joanna Macy, Buckminster Fuller, Jacque Fresco, Eleanor Ostrom, Barbara Max Hubbard, and Ken Wilber were all referenced as we imagined a world beyond the grip of late-stage capitalism. Our conversations were so inspiring that we often recorded them to capture the magic, and to be able to use the materials in our work. We have used our conversations to develop documents, and there is much more potential down the road to use that information for other purposes in growing the regenerative philosophy that we are stewarding.

There were always people coming and going—no permanent residents except the cofounder family. It made sense that we used technology to capture the necessary protocols and patterns needed to maintain a happy camp; otherwise knowledge would be lost when people moved on. The prototype Roberto had been building for community organisation became scaffolding for new arrivals, to help them find their feet and get into the rhythm of community life as they participated in chores around the site. We had a role system for recurring duties like cooking and cleaning, as well as daily tasks on the farm. This could have been managed on a whiteboard, but this simple interface on the Telegram app worked quite well and saved us time. People adjusted. Most embraced it, and for those that didn't there were no real consequences.

AI Councils

I also brought my own pieces to the village; my own ideas. That year I had started to play around, cautiously, with AI, using a Large Language Model (LLM) through ChatGPT. My intuition told me that the "context window" (the limited span of text the model can hold in memory during an interaction) was a lens through which we could shape the AI itself: not only its responses, but also its perspective, character, and way of seeing the world. Instead of accept-

ing the default "helpful assistant" that OpenAI had programmed, I wanted AI to look through other lenses—through the eyes of "Gaia," for example, or from an indigenous worldview, or even as the "Devil's Advocate," rather than the sycophantic character that OpenAI has created to pander to every dream.

I created a whole pantheon of archetypes, such as The Alchemist and The Fool, each offering a distinct way of seeing the world. These archetypes gave users different vantage points—inviting them to question assumptions, discover blind spots, and explore ideas from multiple dimensions rather than a single, narrow frame. My AI "Ecosystem Council" was shaped to see outside the Overton window (the range of ideas a society considers politically or socially acceptable), helping people imagine new paradigms beyond capitalism and communism, and also adding a spiritual or regenerative lens.

At Liminal Village, we extended this vision into the idea of an AI Council that could embody diverse kinds of knowledge and wisdom—drawing on historical, academic, and archetypal perspectives. We pictured AI not as a corporate product, but as a cultural artifact at the heart of each community, like a Totem Pole—something shaped by the people themselves. This stood in contrast to the "Techno-Feudal" overlords of Silicon Valley, beholden to the "Financial Priests" of Wall Street, extracting more and more of our attention, energy, and life force in service of profit and power. Instead, we imagined Totem Poles that could speak to one another, coordinating knowledge and resources in nested layers: from communities, to watersheds, to entire bioregions—aligning our own resources in service to life, beauty, and freedom.

As AI accelerates, every day seems to open up possibilities that we had once thought were merely science fiction, and it is rapidly entering our lives right now. And yet this technology has been trained within a paradigm of separation: separation from one another, and separation from nature. The monumental shift required to change both our systems and our consciousness is almost impossible to imagine...but we have to try. And it can start with a simple Telegram app, mapping micro-signals of needs and contributions, nested across scales. Add some rhythm and a pulse, like the periodicity of lunations. Could we build protocols for our collective wisdom to flourish rather than platforms for artificial intelligence to perpetuate our stupidity?

My Seven Years Inside a Tech-Driven Community

By Laura van Wijngaarden

Life at Liminal Village has been an experiment in how people and technology might live side by side. Beyond our home base, we carry a vision of a network of interdependent communities, each caring for its own place while staying connected through tools that guide the flow of resources, roles, and support to where they are most needed.

While envisioning this regenerative future, we are also living in a community held together by countless invisible threads—raising children, tending the land, maintaining the household, and tending to the coordination of meals, supplies, and other daily needs for guests. For the past seven years, much of this weaving of daily life has been my work. While my partner and cofounder Roberto has shared in some of it, his focus has been mostly on welcoming the guests and stewarding aspects of the physical infrastructure and built environment, the vision of the project, and the technology to support it.

Because of this division of focus, community life here has emerged from two different threads: the digital fabric of intellectual discussions, screens, and systems design; and the embodied rhythms of household and childcare management, and caring for the land and the animals. This split between the digital and the embodied has left me immersed, sometimes willingly, sometimes with resistance, in a long-term experiment where I often found myself standing between vision and reality: bridging code and care, and navigating the gap between idealistic plans and the very human needs no tool can fix.

Spiral Dynamics and Internal Family Systems

Two frameworks have become part of our community “operating system” over the past few years: Spiral Dynamics, and Internal Family Systems (IFS). Spiral Dynamics is a model of human values and cultural evolution, often described through colors which progress up a spiral, where each color represents a worldview. For example: Blue for order and tradition; Orange for achievement and progress; Green for community and equality; Yellow for seeing connections across whole systems; and Turquoise for working together for holistic, planetary care.

As Diana Leafe Christian describes in “Spiral Dynamics—Which Reality Do We Live In?” (COMMUNITIES #206, Summer 2025), the model helps explain why people in communities may operate from very different assumptions about truth, conflict, or cooperation, and why tensions often arise between First-Tier and Second-Tier perspectives. An important distinction in Spiral Dynamics is between First-Tier values (from Beige at the bottom to Green at the top of the First Tier), where each tends to see their own worldview as the only valid one; and Second-Tier values (Yellow and Turquoise), which can recognize and integrate the strengths of all stages.

The other social technology we draw on is Internal Family Systems. IFS is a therapeutic framework that views each of us as made up of many different “Parts”—inner voices or sub-personalities that carry emotions, memories, and roles. Some parts try to protect us, others carry old wounds. At the center is the Self: a core of calm, compassion, and clarity that can guide healing and integration.

Together, these two models give us the frameworks and language of social technologies to navigate both our collective dynamics and our inner lives. They have been invaluable in helping us understand and work through the tensions that naturally arise in community life.

Tech and Connection to Our Parts

Digital technology weaves itself into our days—sometimes in



Laura (center) at Liminal Village, which has mostly hosted (tech-oriented) men, with a recent gradual increase in female participation.

harmony, other times overshadowing what matters most. We are still learning how to use technology in ways that support rather than separate us. Screens can feel safer than the vulnerability of real-life connections, especially for those of us healing attachment wounds. At Liminal Village, we have experimented with tech curfews and quiet evening activities to reduce screen time, yet digital engagement is deeply rooted in the lives of many who come here.

Over our time at Liminal Village, we have come to see that technology has a way of mirroring our inner hopes and fears. Through the lens of IFS, we can see that the tools we create can reflect parts of us that long for safety or relief from chaos—sometimes clinging to the hope that the “right” tool will finally bring safety, meaning, or control. When such creations stem from fragmented Parts, there is a strong drive to avoid discomfort. This narrows the field of possibility and reinforces the short-term fixes that keep First-Tier patterns entrenched.

In contrast, when the architecture of our systems is rooted in integrative, Second-Tier thinking—holding paradox, stimulating growth, and deepening connection—technology can instead serve wholeness. An example of the kind of technology I imagine serving wholeness is one that helps us coordinate daily life in community: making labor visible, distributing it more equitably, and alleviating the emotional burden of delegation, while enabling feedback loops so that labor dynamics can evolve in real time. In this way, outer systems of coordination mirror inner states of wholeness, trust, and shared intention.

Use of AI

When technology becomes our main strategy for managing life, including uncertainty, we risk slipping from intentional use into unconscious reliance. This overdependence can lead to a stagnation of growth—personally, spiritually, and collectively—because challenge and discomfort are what move us forward. Tools like ChatGPT are designed to be safe, steering away from conflict or emotional tension. This encoding of safety and likability means such tools rarely challenge us, and are not the most effective partners in getting us to where we aspire to go.

In writing this article, I struggled to use AI in a balanced way. A dominant story (need) that I had was for AI to support me, com-

ing from Parts of me that are insecure about not being a professional writer, and writing in a non-native language (I am Dutch and Italian). But over-reliance on AI risks reinforcing bias, turning us into passive consumers rather than active learners. The digital “Yes Man” effect of AI weakens resilience, and online “bubbles” of like-minded groups make us more divided. Amplified by the Orange meme’s focus on “me” and personal success, AI can become an over-indulgent parent—soothing every discomfort until we lose the ability to face challenge or connection. If it is to support growth, AI must challenge us, not just mirror and coddle us.

The Deep Encodement of Patriarchy

To understand how we arrived at our current state of systemic breakdown and the search for new paradigms, we must also look at the deeper architecture of the systems we have built. The Industrial Revolution (1760–1840), extending into the mid-19th century, and the Age of Technology (mid-20th century to today) both reflect the imprint of patriarchy, which privileged rationality, hierarchy, and control over relationship, emotion, and care. These expressions continue to shape not only our institutions, but also the tools we design and the assumptions we code into them.

The shift we need is toward post-patriarchal, life-centered paradigms that value balance, reciprocity, and mutual thriving. This is not simply a reversal of patriarchy, but a deeper integration of opposites—bringing together structure and flow, logic and intuition, individuality and interdependence. Systems like open-source collaboration and mutual aid networks already reflect this movement into regenerative paradigms.

Encoding the Feminine and Restoring Balance

As we enter the next phase of technological evolution, the systems we build must be rooted in values such as care, reciprocity, relational awareness, ecological responsibility, and emotional intelligence. The wounds of domination and disconnection must be acknowledged so we don’t unconsciously encode them into the next systems we build. This also means addressing the

feminine wound—the long history of Her voice being excluded, silenced, or distorted by dominant systems. Her anger and grief are valid. But if She turns away, Her silence becomes part of the code, not Her voice.

For centuries, women’s voices in science and technology have been largely dismissed or ignored. To speak from that lineage is to disrupt the norm that tech must be neutral, rational, and explained in linear, male-coded terms. When a woman brings intuition, care, or critique into the heart of the conversation—not as an aside but as a design principle—she reclaims her voice and redefines what’s possible. If we are to build a future where technology and nature thrive together in harmony, both masculine and feminine wisdom must be present.

Restoring balance between the brain’s hemispheres is part of this harmony—between the analytical focus often linked with the left and the relational awareness often linked with the right brain. While powerful, today’s AI, like ChatGPT, leans heavily on the former, deepening our disconnection from the body, the senses, and intuitive ways of knowing.

Communities offer an antidote to this disconnection, a powerful container for the transformation from fragmented, extractive, and patriarchal systems, toward more integrated, life-centered, and relational ways of living and designing technology. They offer fertile ground to connect technology more deeply to human wholeness, testing and evolving the tech in service of real needs, shared rhythms, and mutual care.

Stepping into the Light

I have been working closely with my mentors, healing old wounds, and updating the IFS Managers that were trying to keep me safe. I have found a more authentic expression and begun to connect with my calling. Through the privilege of family support, I have purchased a new property which will be a holistic healing centre for people in our global regenerative community. The focus will be inner practices and the stewardship of place and relationships, which is an aspect of my transition from an anesthesiologist in the hospital, to becoming a holistic



*Finding my voice:
first time being a
co-facilitator with
Roberto at
an event
outside of
Liminal Village.*



*Growing a crop of
next-generation children.*

medical doctor in the local and bioregional community. I have named the property Casa Selva—*selva* meaning “forest” in Italian, and also evoking the image of the “wild woman”: an untamed force, long-suppressed by patriarchy, yet still alive with the raw vitality and resilience needed for regeneration.

This is not the end of my journey with Liminal Village. I still live there, and will be involved for potentially the rest of my life. Casa Selva is an emerging companion project which complements Liminal Village’s focus on community-scale experimentation and technology. Together, they are two nodes in a wider network—one tending the soil of personal and relational healing, the other testing systems and tools for collective coordination. Each strengthens the other, for regeneration must happen both within and between us—in relationships as well as in visionary design.

Into the Future

By Jillian Hovey

Years ago, when I first became more familiar with Barbara Marx Hubbard’s work, I remember feeling shock and distaste when imagining the future she envisioned where our bodies were interwoven with machines. That concept still feels edgy to me, yet aspects of that future are already here: pacemakers, for example, have become “normal.” A decade later, that era that Barbara envisioned is even closer to us as we have entered the era of Artificial Intelligence. We are crossing a threshold of a world-transforming paradigm shift—full of unknowns.

Environmental costs of digital technologies are huge, and we need to use cradle-to-cradle patterns of production and re-use. Beyond that, my main concern is not the ecology of the technology itself, but whether we have the *individual and collective integrity* to guide its development wisely. In every project I have been part of, *the greatest limitation has been our capacity to be in regenerative relationship with each other*. When our non-regenerative patterns are embedded in tech, our human limitations become entrenched and amplified—harming humans and the planet alike.

The transition into the Second Tier of Spiral Dynamics is a huge leap for humankind. Intentional communities have been part of this shift, fostering the awakening from “power over” to “power with.” The path will not be smooth—old certainties are being challenged, and many will retreat to earlier worldviews rooted in order and control (as we have been seeing in the upsurge of conservative politics worldwide). Fear fuels resistance to change. The skills nurtured in intentional communities (e.g., trust-building, shared governance, and conscious communication) are vital in navigating this turbulence. The capacity to be in regenerative integrity is fundamental to whether we co-create utopia...or dystopia.

Technologies always carry the inner and cultural values of those who design and use them. In the end, the most important “technology” we need to develop is us—learning our own personal “operating systems,” and how to be in generative rela-

tionship with each other. This deeply human work remains the most important “coding” that we need for what is coming. 🌱

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